Teaching Evaluations: Unabridged Reports

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About this document

This appendix reproduces in full the student evaluations summarised in my *Teaching Evaluations* document: every quantitative question with its complete distribution of answers, and every written comment, for each course and cohort. It covers the two courses I designed and taught as primary instructor:

- *Applied Microeconomics*, Downing College Summer Programme, University of Cambridge, 2025: three cohorts (Programmes A, B and C), 38 respondents in total;
- *Economics and Entrepreneurship*, Mawhiba International Enrichment Programme, King Saud University, Riyadh: 2023 (20 respondents) and 2024 (16 respondents).

Survey instruments. Both programmes used an anonymous end-of-course online questionnaire (Google Forms) with two questions rated on a 1–5 scale, closed questions on the course, and open questions for comments. For *Applied Microeconomics* the source is the exported spreadsheet of individual responses, so every figure below is computed from the raw responses. For *Economics and Entrepreneurship* the questionnaire was administered by the programme organiser (Oxmedica), which sent me the form's summary report by email after each course. The distributions below are transcribed from the charts in that report, and the comments are reproduced as they appear in it. Neither source records respondents' names or email addresses.

Editing. Comments are reproduced verbatim, including spelling, grammar, capitalisation and punctuation, and nothing has been shortened, corrected or omitted. The only changes are: (i) the first name with which one student signed a comment is replaced by [name], and a colleague's first name in the organiser's covering note for 2023 by [another staff member]; (ii) emoji, which cannot be typeset here, are removed, and each affected comment is marked †; (iii) full-width (East Asian) punctuation marks are set as their standard equivalents and marked ‡; (iv) leading and trailing spaces are removed. The 2024 *Economics and Entrepreneurship* questionnaire also asked students to rate a teaching assistant, another member of staff; that question is omitted because it does not concern my teaching. No other questions are omitted. Shares are percentages of respondents to the question, rounded to one decimal place; means are computed from the counts.

1. Applied Microeconomics, Downing College Summer Programme, Cambridge, 2025

Lecturer and course designer. The course was taught to three successive international cohorts in summer 2025, each of which completed the same questionnaire ("Applied Microeconomics Course Feedback") at the end of the course. Respondents identified their cohort in the first question ("Which programme/cohort did you participate in?"): Programme A, 16 respondents; Programme B, 13; Programme C, 9; 38 in total. Responses were submitted on 24 July 2025 (Programme A), 1 August 2025 (Programme B) and 21 August 2025 (Programme C). One response recorded as Programme A was submitted on 1 August 2025, the day Programme B completed the survey; it is reported under the cohort the respondent selected.

All three cohorts pooled ($N = 38$)

Question (1–5 scale)	1	2	3	4	5	N	Mean
How would you rate Mr. Fergus McCormack's knowledge and expertise?	0 (0.0%)	1 (2.6%)	0 (0.0%)	1 (2.6%)	36 (94.7%)	38	4.89
How would you rate Mr. Fergus McCormack's overall inspiration and engagement?	1 (2.6%)	1 (2.6%)	0 (0.0%)	3 (7.9%)	33 (86.8%)	38	4.74

Did this course improve your scientific knowledge?		
Answer	n	*Share*
Yes	37	97.4%
No	0	0.0%
Other (free-text answer)	1	2.6%
Total	38	100.0%

The free-text answer reads: "I got to learn more about the topics i have read about before and got introduced to programming and it's link with economics".

How did you find the scientific content of the course?		
Answer	n	*Share*
It was just right	31	81.6%
It was too advanced	7	18.4%
Total	38	100.0%

Only the answers shown were recorded.

Was there a good balance between lectures, activities and practical sessions?		
Answer	n	*Share*
Yes	38	100.0%
No	0	0.0%
Total	38	100.0%

1a. Applied Microeconomics, 2025: Programme A ($N = 16$)

Question (1–5 scale)	1	2	3	4	5	N	Mean
How would you rate Mr. Fergus McCormack's knowledge and expertise?	0 (0.0%)	1 (6.3%)	0 (0.0%)	1 (6.3%)	14 (87.5%)	16	4.75
How would you rate Mr. Fergus McCormack's overall inspiration and engagement?	1 (6.3%)	1 (6.3%)	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	14 (87.5%)	16	4.56

Did this course improve your scientific knowledge?		
Answer	n	*Share*
Yes	16	100.0%
No	0	0.0%
Total	16	100.0%

How did you find the scientific content of the course?		
Answer	*n*	*Share*
It was just right	10	62.5%
It was too advanced	6	37.5%
Total	16	100.0%

Only the answers shown were recorded.

Was there a good balance between lectures, activities and practical sessions?		
Answer	*n*	*Share*
Yes	16	100.0%
No	0	0.0%
Total	16	100.0%

Please give a couple of comments if you answered no to the previous question.

0 entries.

No responses.

Which topic(s) of the course did you enjoy the most?

16 entries.

- all
- finance
- Economics of education
- Saving lives with economics
- R Studio
- Microeconomics
- knowledge about GDP and demand supply
- Probably the data analysis
- Emperical project
- Economics
- The GDP one
- Empirical project
- kahoot
- I enjoyed the data analysis/coding and the gdp topic the most, I found that learning how to manage and work with data sets and apply it myself was a very useful skill that I learned. I also enjoyed the GDP topic because I'm generally interested in the economic states of countries and how GDP/GDPPC effects a countries wealth.
- I quite enjoyed the last session, about GDP etc.
- gdp

What could be done to improve the course?

16 entries.

- none
- more interactions between students and teachers
- A more composed narrative would be helpful.
- Perhaps adding more fun stuff

- I think Mr Fergus did his best job, i really enjoyed, there is no room for improvement
- more interaction
- more break time
- The empirical project was really hard and i struggled
- Easier
- increase the breaktime
- make the empirical project easier†
- no
- Maybe project can be easier
- The coding project had a hard barrier of entry, but once you get everything setup and start coding it gets much easier.
- I think the projects could be a bit simpler, but overall the projects were enjoyable nonetheless
- no

Any last comments for Mr. Fergus McCormack?

16 entries.

- good
- you're great
- I didnt find the course helpful.
- No†
- Thank you so much Mr Fergus, i wish to be your student in the future (if I successfully joined the college)
- Good
- good
- Thanks you so much
- No
- no
- He is great
- no
- Thank you Nice to meet you†
- Thank you! It was really fun to be in your class and I genuinely enjoyed discussing topics with you and learning in your class!
- It was wonderful having you as a teacher for these 2 weeks, and I enjoy your laugh a lot as well
- No comments

1b. Applied Microeconomics, 2025: Programme B ($N = 13$)

Question (1–5 scale)	1	2	3	4	5	N	Mean
How would you rate Mr. Fergus McCormack's knowledge and expertise?	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	13 (100.0%)	13	5.00
How would you rate Mr. Fergus McCormack's overall inspiration and engagement?	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	3 (23.1%)	10 (76.9%)	13	4.77

Did this course improve your scientific knowledge?		
Answer	*n*	*Share*
Yes	13	100.0%
No	0	0.0%
Total	13	100.0%

How did you find the scientific content of the course?		
Answer	*n*	*Share*
It was just right	12	92.3%
It was too advanced	1	7.7%
Total	13	100.0%

Only the answers shown were recorded.

Was there a good balance between lectures, activities and practical sessions?		
Answer	*n*	*Share*
Yes	13	100.0%
No	0	0.0%
Total	13	100.0%

Please give a couple of comments if you answered no to the previous question.

1 entry.

- Everything is good but coding is quite challenging.

Which topic(s) of the course did you enjoy the most?

13 entries.

- all[†]
- GDP, sustainability and ethics
- genetics
- everything
- Applied microeconomics theory
- Economics saving lives
- GDP
- Taxes and GDP
- Tax and GDP
- taxes and gdp
- GDP and ethics
- Lecture of GDP and sustainability
- GDP,inequality,and sustainability[‡]

What could be done to improve the course?

13 entries.

- Nothing, fantastic course
- -
- more game?[‡]
- perfection

- More tutorials or instructions about coding so it would be easier for us to use R Studio to analyse the data.
- None! Really great†
- Make the empirical project more simple, it is quite difficult†
- It was quite good
- More class?
- it was good
- Having more discussion parts.
- More guidance on R programming and empirical tasks.
- One emperical project is enough hahah

Any last comments for Mr. Fergus McCormack?

13 entries.

- Very good†
- -
- greatttt
- Absolute cinema!
- I learned a lot but the coding was quite difficult
- Thank you so much for your lessons. I have learnt a lot and I really enjoy your lessons!!!†
- Thank u for teaching†
- Happy to have a teacher like him
- I learn a lot of things, such a fantastic experience. Thank you and I like your fashion style.
- I learned a lot of things during the course and it helped a lot to decide me selecting economics for university.
- Really interesting teacher. Didn‘t have the chance to tell him he looks like Nicola Tesla.
- Let the program C do the all empirical tasks. And the teacher is so kind and handsome, he taught very well.
- Thank you so much for teaching us. I can't imagine myself writing code in the class because it's hard to give a first try. But I nailed it, it's a big surprise and new experience for me. Thank you! You are so nice!†

1c. Applied Microeconomics, 2025: Programme C ($N = 9$)

Question (1–5 scale)	1	2	3	4	5	N	Mean
How would you rate Mr. Fergus McCormack's knowledge and expertise?	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	9 (100.0%)	9	5.00
How would you rate Mr. Fergus McCormack's overall inspiration and engagement?	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	9 (100.0%)	9	5.00

Did this course improve your scientific knowledge?		
Answer	*n*	*Share*
Yes	8	88.9%
No	0	0.0%
Other (free-text answer)	1	11.1%
Total	9	100.0%

The free-text answer reads: "I got to learn more about the topics i have read about before and got introduced to programming and it's link with economics".

How did you find the scientific content of the course?		
Answer	*n*	*Share*
It was just right	9	100.0%
Total	9	100.0%

Only the answers shown were recorded.

Was there a good balance between lectures, activities and practical sessions?		
Answer	*n*	*Share*
Yes	9	100.0%
No	0	0.0%
Total	9	100.0%

Please give a couple of comments if you answered no to the previous question.

0 entries.

No responses.

Which topic(s) of the course did you enjoy the most?

9 entries.

- Taxation
- GDP
- GDP,TAX‡
- all
- the R code
- Taxation
- Income taxation
- I found the topic about economic of education is quite interesting, and the project we did is also very inspiring.
- The kahoots(quizzes) and the lecture about genetic modification

What could be done to improve the course?

9 entries.

- Maybe more realistic example for explaining
- add more break
- It is already wonderful
- may increase the activity
- it is good
- Not much

- More class activities if possible
- I found the lecture about genetics and economics is a bit difficult to understand, maybe the lecture can be split into two in order to help us to have a deeper understanding.
- I don't know if this is possible but i feel that the lectures are too long, not just for applied microeconomics but for other disciplines as well. As a student, i tend to lose focus after a certain amount of time and it gets tiring.

Any last comments for Mr. Fergus McCormack?

9 entries.

- No
- no
- Good good very good†
- nothing
- it is good
- Thanks for teaching us! It was great.
- Keep granting
- No, every thing is pretty good.
- I would like to thank him for teaching us with so much enthusiasm and interest. It was truly one of the best experiences i've had in a classroom and i got to learn so much about the subject that i am passionate about because of him.

2. Economics and Entrepreneurship, Mawhiba International Enrichment Programme, King Saud University, 2023 ($N = 20$)

Lecturer and course designer; three-week intensive course, 20 students. Source: summary report of the end-of-course questionnaire, emailed to me by the programme organiser on 16 August 2023. The covering email described the feedback as follows: "Below you will find your final student feedback. It is very strong! Both [another staff member] and I truly appreciated the level of effort and preparation you put into your teaching, and as you will see it shows in the feedback."

Question (1–5 scale)	1	2	3	4	5	N	Mean
How would you evaluate Mr Fergus's knowledge and expertise?	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	5 (25.0%)	15 (75.0%)	20	4.75
How would you evaluate Mr Fergus's inspiration and engagement?	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	2 (10.0%)	18 (90.0%)	20	4.90

Did the course improve your scientific knowledge?		
Answer	*n*	*Share*
Yes	20	100.0%
No	0	0.0%
Total	20	100.0%

How did you find the scientific content of your class?		
Answer	*n*	*Share*
It was just right	17	85.0%
It was too advanced	2	10.0%
It was too simple	1	5.0%
Total	20	100.0%

The chart labels the first two shares (85% and 10%); the third slice is unlabelled and its count is the remainder.

Was there a good balance between classroom lessons, activities and practical sessions (for eg. labs)?		
Answer	*n*	*Share*
Yes	17	85.0%
No	3	15.0%
Total	20	100.0%

Which topic(s) of the course did you enjoy the most?

16 entries (the survey report states 18 responses). Each entry is one response box as displayed in the summary report. Line breaks are as in the report; where an entry contains several lines it may combine more than one response.

- Entrepreneurship
- Start ups
- Supply and Demand, Tax, Entreprenurial thinking.
- Finance
- entrepreneurship
- all of them but mostly the entrepreneurship
- The entrepreneurship
- Oil
- Enterpreneurship
- Supply and demand, investing, and kahoot.
- Funding
- Start ups and the reasons they fail
- 2008 financial crisis
- Supply and demand
- Creating a startup and the fiscal and monetary policy
- The Arabic/ A1-A2/B1-B2 class was great
  The English classes and the extra classes were also great
  And the most interesting topic was entrepreneurship
  Economics was good but entrepreneurship was WAYYYY more interesting especially with the stuff related about actions/feelings
  Like leadership or persuasion

Please give a couple of comments if you answered no to the previous question.

3 entries (the survey report states 3 responses).

- The activities need to have more time
- No comment

- Best RA and TA and teacher

Last comments for Mr Fergus?

16 entries (the survey report states 18 responses). Each entry is one response box as displayed in the summary report. Line breaks are as in the report; where an entry contains several lines it may combine more than one response.

- Best teacher
- Thank you
- Wish to learn more and understand more from you.
- thank you so much your lessons were really fun
- The best teacher and I learned alot from him
- Thank you very much for everything you have done for us , an extremely fun and memorable journey
  Your student,
  [name]
- Inspirational teacher
- Best tutor
- He was good teacher and good brother
- Mr Fergus is the best. I wish him the best.
- Amazing
- He is a great teacher
- You couldn't have gotten a better teacher
- Thank you very much, comeback next year if you may and we will all love to see you
- Mr fetus is an amazing teacher and he provided the exact environment for creative learning
- I will miss you so much
  And he is the best teacher ever if you can let him come next year again
  He was a great teacher

3. Economics and Entrepreneurship, Mawhiba International Enrichment Programme, King Saud University, 2024 ($N = 16$)

Lecturer and course designer; three-week intensive course, 16 students. Source: summary report of the end-of-course questionnaire, emailed to me by the programme organiser on 28 July 2024. The covering email described the feedback as follows: "Below you will find your (excellent) feedback. Thanks for doing such a fantastic job." The questionnaire's third rating question ("How would you evaluate your TA's overall helpfulness in class and approachability?") concerns another member of staff and is omitted.

Question (1–5 scale)	1	2	3	4	5	N	Mean
How would you evaluate Mr. Fergus' knowledge and expertise?	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	5 (31.3%)	11 (68.8%)	16	4.69
How would you evaluate Mr. Fergus' overall inspiration and engagement?	0 (0.0%)	0 (0.0%)	1 (6.3%)	2 (12.5%)	13 (81.3%)	16	4.75

Did the course improve your scientific knowledge?		
Answer	*n*	*Share*
Yes	14	87.5%
No	2	12.5%
Total	16	100.0%

How did you find the scientific content of your class?		
Answer	*n*	*Share*
It was just right	12	75.0%
It was too advanced	2	12.5%
It was too simple	2	12.5%
Total	16	100.0%

Did you find your course trip excursion useful and interesting?		
Answer	*n*	*Share*
Yes	15	93.8%
No	1	6.3%
Total	16	100.0%

The chart labels only the larger share (93.8%); the count for "No" is the remainder.

Was there a good balance between classroom lessons, activities and practical sessions (for eg. labs)?		
Answer	*n*	*Share*
Yes	14	87.5%
No	2	12.5%
Total	16	100.0%

Please give a couple of comments if you answered no to the previous question.

6 entries (the survey report states 6 responses). In this report responses appear as consecutive lines of text rather than separate boxes; each line is shown as one entry.

- -
- We have went to the computer lad only once in the entire 3weeks
- No
- .
- I think the students should be asked about what they like and want to do more to make sure everyone gets benefit no matter the reasons they joined the program
- I didn't answer no

Which topic(s) of the course did you enjoy the most?

14 entries (the survey report states 15 responses). In this report responses appear as consecutive lines of text rather than separate boxes; each line is shown as one entry. The report lists 14 lines for 15 responses; one response is not reproduced in the report.

- how graphs explain budget constraints, indifference curves and supply & demand
- Gdp
- characteristics of entrepreneurs and starting a business
- Supply and demand
- The entrepreneurship side of things and going to BIM studios

- Micro economics or consumer theory
- Understanding the entrepreneur part of businesses, I.e: understanding how businesses are started, what is needed, how to fund it. But i found the economics part to be quite useful as well too.
- Supply and demand/equilibrium
- the graphing is really cool when you understand it
- The trip that took us to a Venture Capital Firm
- Investing
- Supply and demand
- I enjoyed economics and I fell involve with it's broad definition and the impact of the economy on the world
- going to him studios and seeing how companies develop from that

Last comments for Mr. Fergus?

17 entries (the survey report states 15 responses). In this report responses appear as consecutive lines of text rather than separate boxes; each line is shown as one entry. The exception is the letter-style response beginning "Dear Mr Furges", whose paragraphs are kept together as one entry. Because the report shows 17 entries for 15 responses, some consecutive entries may belong to the same response.

- his teaching is sometimes not very clear, he brought a lot about things in the final test we took about very minimally. however he is extremely clear and open for questions and queries
- it was so interesting being a student to a very intelligent person he was so good with the students and after every slide he asks if there is any questions or no
- he is the greatest teacher in the history of teachers
- Mr Ferguson is a master at what he does i love the way he teaches I love the way he engages with us students I think he is probably the best teacher I ever had in my entire life I feel likes he's more than a teacher and a rather an older brother that I can talk to outside of class , take advice from and have a chat w him where I feel comfortable he's one of the key things in this program and I'll always remember him forever
- Mr Fergus is genuinely the greatest teacher that I have ever met in person he's a great teacher, very great person and very intelligent. He cares a lot about the students and works just as hard as us to make sure every single one of us passes the course and gets a good grade. I think he deserves a bonus for juggling his work life and his student life because he is working to get his PhD. I will remember what Mr Fergus taught me and his kindness towards us because he understood that we were a group of young men who are far from home for the first time and he completely understood and tried helping us through a difficult time.†
- Dear Mr Furges

  At the beginning of the program i thought you were going to be boring and non-active. And it turns out i am wrong, Mr Fergus, you are one of and not if the best teacher i have ever had to teach me and it was truly an honor to have met you.

  Your classes are never boring and almost all of them contain your fun twist and your charisma toward each sentence that i have learnt and i just want to say.

  Thank you†
- He was the best, most fun, kindest and caring teacher here by far and I still think he needs a bonus and a pay raise,
- No
- BEST TEACHER EVER
- Amazing teacher and wont forget him

- He is an amazing tutor.
- Thank you for everything Mr. Fergus!
- I will miss you and your classes. They were fun and engaging and your personality was the best among all the other doctors in my opinion.
- It was nice to meet you and i hope we can meet again!
- Amazing teacher and I'm glad I got to meat him and learn all that he had to teach
- you're the best teacher you have the perfect ratio of good and hard work and fun with jokes as well he deserves a pay raise you are the best, keep on working hard and never give up . again give this man a raise he deserves it.[†]
- The best teacher

4. Additional comment from a mid-course feedback questionnaire

The following written comment, from an *Economics and Entrepreneurship* student, is a response to a mid-course feedback questionnaire (2024), separate from the end-of-course surveys reported above. I do not have access to the rest of that questionnaire's results, so only this comment is included. It is transcribed verbatim.

- He is amazing. He inspires me to be the best and smartest economist I can be as well as the most clever, innovative, and intuitive entrepreneur I can be. He is bright man with an even glamorous future ahead of him. I hope he has the best life he can get. His shimmering presence guides all of his great full students in the path of success and victory. His classes are like a mighty tree on the blazing sun in which you can safely seek refuge against the dangers of the world. His fashion sense encourages to step out of our shells and be, not only the the best selves we can be, but truest selves we can be.